

Face-2-Face with Employer

“Analytics is currently neglected in India. We expect to see jobs in this space for as many as 1,00,000 people over the next five years.”

Ashish Gupta,
COO of Evalueserve

bringing out the best in me and my team.

What are the required skill sets?

The most important skills required to work in this job are as follows:

- **Logical and analytical thinking:** I was not from a statistics background but have been able to do well because of my logical thinking.
- **Eye for detail:** Data Analytics is about putting the smallest pieces together to get to the big picture. It is very important to have an eye for detail. You can't afford to go wrong; you have to be 100 per cent accurate and that can only come from analysing to minute detail.
- **Passion and ability to work with numbers:** A number-crunching role has to be driven by a passion and ability to work with numbers. There has to be a huge comfort level.
- **Work in teams:** For every project, you have to work in a team and deliver the solution for a client. You have to look at the bigger picture and work towards that goal for the benefit of the organisation.

What about the Mind Set?

It's not a lazy man's job! It requires lots of hard work, sense for numbers and technical capabilities. Knowledge of packages such as SAS and SPSS is helpful in this career. Business acumen as a mind set is critical to the profession; one needs to know the over all business environment of the client, economic scenario and how they should make their decisions.

Attributes needed for the job include statistical skills, IT-savvy and project management experience. Detail-oriented; excellent analytics skills and the ability to translate and conceptualise statistical information to determine user habits and trends; an understanding of web navigation and user habits; HTML knowledge required, Java and Active Server Page experience come in handy.

Analytics require strong attention to detail, quantitative acumen, hard work, and ability to think creatively in terms of how to design test and control for strategy building. An ability to pick up programming languages fast is a must as the large amounts of data is manipulated using software.

Sample Job Description for a Risk Analyst

Summary of Position

Provides analytical and/or MIS (Management Information System) support for various credit policies, risk and/or marketing related functions.

Principal Accountabilities

- Provide support for analytical research projects and/or statistical models to include project design, data collection, database design, analysis and presentation of results.
- Conduct cost and profitability studies of customer groups, merchants and/or loan types for business unit operations. Evaluate and implement internal and external credit scoring using traditional and advanced forms of predictive technology.
- Complete analysis and document results of alternative risk management options and credit risk issues. Design and prepare analyses of operating data; formally present findings to management.
- Analyze loan and customer credit risk performance using corporate databases. Utilize external scoring and/or management software packages to aid in manag-